

What A Run Chart Shows

The map and histogram are snapshots; the run chart watches the process move over time.

Watching Over Time

Real processes do not hold still. They drift, better on a good week and worse on a bad one. The single most important question in improvement is about time. Did the thing we changed actually make a difference. A snapshot can never answer that. A run chart plots a point for each time period and connects the dots.

The Story It Tells

This humble chart does what the average and even the histogram cannot. It shows the story of your process over time. It shows trends, the slow creep up or down. It shows sudden shifts, the day everything changed. And it shows whether your proud change actually moved the line or you are just seeing normal bouncing around.

Where AI Fits

Reacting to noise as if it were signal is one of the most common and expensive mistakes in business. AI plots these charts instantly and helps interpret them, spotting a likely trend or suspicious jump. But it cannot know you launched a new tool that Monday. Connecting the movement in the line to events in reality is the human's job.

Remember this

A run chart tells real change from a process just being its normal bouncy self.